Mikayla Acosta

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EDUCATION

UC Berkeley Berkeley, CA
B. A. Data Science and Economics Expected May 2028

WORK EXPERIENCE AND PROJECTS

Human-Centered Design Interface Consultant September 2026 - December 2026
ASUS ProArt- Contracted through Berkeley Innovation Berkeley, CA

- Conducting user research to understand creators' workflows, decision-making, and interactions with AI agents, identifying opportunities to optimize AI automation while preserving creative autonomy and critical judgment.
- Translating research insights into actionable product recommendations, user flows, clickable prototypes, and a comprehensive research report.

Human-Centered Design Interface Consultant September 2025 - December 2025
Notability- Contracted through Berkeley Innovation Berkeley, CA

- Led ideation for AI-driven, personalized study features in Notability, targeting accessibility and engagement for students.
- Synthesized 10+ interviews, 3+ diary studies, and secondary research to prioritize high-impact features (personalized onboarding, guided study sessions, subject-specific AI tutor).
- Presented our research in feature prioritization and prototype recommendations with a finalized slide deck and demos

Project Manager January 2026 - May 2026
REDO- Contracted through Software Product @ Cal Berkeley, CA

- Produced product strategy and execution for a referral rewards feature, transforming post-purchase customers into acquisition channels
- Defined feature requirements and user flows for the merchant dashboard, referral generation, and reward triggers while developing a product case study integrating user research, product decisions, go-to-market strategy, and a marketing website.

Product Management Consultant September 2025 - December 2025
ZocDoc- Contracted through Software Product @ Cal Berkeley, CA

- Conducted mixed-methods user research (10 interviews + survey of 254 Gen Z students) to uncover trust drivers and decision patterns in digital healthcare booking
- Defined three user archetypes and journey maps, pinpointing friction in provider discovery, trust, and booking.
- Translated research into product recommendations to improve Gen Z conversion and trust, including social-style patient testimonials, student-specific trust signals, and parent-collaboration features

Accounts Payable Associate Intern May 2026 - August 2026
Malcolm Drilling Company, Inc San Francisco, CA

- Managed invoices, bills, and purchase orders across company finances, verifying accuracy, maintaining records, and flagging billing discrepancies.
- Supported the company's central accounting hub by tracking financial activity and organizing accounts payable operations across nationwide branches.

Software Intern June 2025 - July 2025
Hubmaster- Software Intern Barcelona, Spain

- Tasked with the transition between technology platforms–JMobile to PLC Designer– for HMI (Human-Machine Interface) screens used to manually control and supervise autonomous warehouse operations.

HONORS & PRESENTATIONS

Speaker at the International Software Product Management Association February 2026
Software Product @ Cal Bangalore, India

- Delivered a presentation at an international product management conference, showcasing the growth and cross-functional project impact of UC Berkeley's ISPMA student chapter to global PM leaders
- Analyzed trends in AI-driven development, global-first design, and value-based strategy through engagement with industry product leaders